

OARS: Motivational Interviewing (MI) in Action

Open-ended questions Ask clients what they already know or are doing to reach their goals.	“What are some ways that you could add more vegetables to your diet?”
Affirming Builds a client’s confidence in their ability to change by recognizing the barriers they are trying to overcome and pointing out their strengths	“I know you had to juggle a lot this week with work and your family. Your commitment really shows by your being here today to speak with me.”
Reflecting Shows the client you understand their point of view without judging, criticizing, or blaming them for their actions	“It sounds like you are really trying hard to reach your weight loss goal. But you are also frustrated because you haven’t found the right plan for you yet.”
Summarizing Repeating the key parts of the discussion to help the client work through their ambivalence so they can move toward change	“I’d like to review a number of important points you made. You are really bothered by the way you have been feeling lately. You feel out of breath when you are walking to your office or playing with your children. At the same time, you have been eating a lot more fast food for lunch because you don’t feel you have the time to prepare your food in advance. I would like to know how you would like to move forward based on what you have told me so far.”

MI Style: 0 to 10 Scale to Assess Readiness to Change

1. Why would you want to make this change?
2. On a scale of 0-10, 0 being not important at all, and 10 most important, how important is it for you to make this change? OR How confident are you that you can make this change?
3. Why are you at a _____, and not a zero?
4. What would it take to get you from “that number” to “one number higher?”
5. What are the 3 main reasons you want to make this change?
6. What ideas do you have about making these changes?
7. So, what will you do next?

Kick Start Change: Importance/Confidence Indicators

Importance/Interest: On a scale from 0 to 10, where 0 is “not at all important” and 10 is “very important”, how Important is it for you to _____?

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Confidence: On a scale from 0 to 10, where 0 is “not at all confident” and 10 “is very confident”, how confident are you that you *could* make these changes if you decided to _____?

Reference

Miller, R. M., Rollnick, S. (2012). Motivational interviewing: Helping people change. (3rd ed.). New York: NY: Guilford Press.